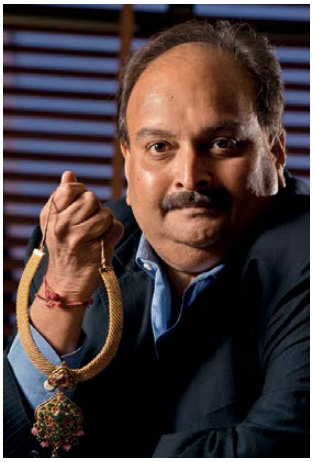


BANDEEP SINGH/FORTUNE INDIA



RACHIT GOSWAMI



CHANDRADEEP KUMAR

vulnerabilities in cooperative banking. In 2020, Yes Bank required an emergency RBI-led rescue while founder Rana Kapoor was arrested in connection with alleged financial irregularities, a case that has later widened to include loans extended to entities linked to Anil Ambani.

Then in 2023, a report by US short-seller Hindenburg triggered a global sell-off in Adani Group stocks over governance and leverage concerns, all of which the conglomerate denied. By 2025, the spotlight had shifted to the startup economy, with investigations into BluSmart and Gensol exposing alleged fund diversion, stock manipulation and forgery—casting a shadow over two fast-rising players in India's EV cab and green energy space, and underscoring how scale had once again outpaced safeguards. ■

How to Bust a Bank
Mar. 23, 2020



"Yes Bank was an accident waiting to happen. The fact that NPA divergences continued for three years exposes the bank's first line of custodians—its internal and external auditors. They failed as much as the bank management to assess the real status of the bank's NPAs. The auditors should have noticed any deterioration in collateral value, the financial position of borrowers and cash flows. The bank's board, too, remained a mute spectator, as long as Rana Kapoor brought high growth and profitability to the bank."

FOCUS
ARTISTS

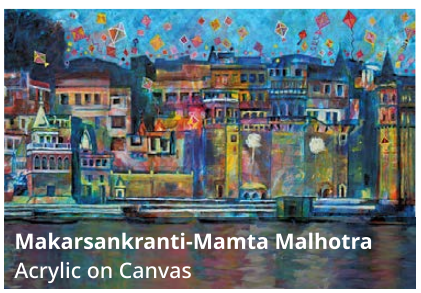
CUBISM TO VARANASI'S SPIRIT

Artists Bharati Shah & Mamta Malhotra Envision New India



Bharati Shah
Artist

For Bharati Shah, art is where unspoken emotions find shape, serving as an escape from a childhood where she often felt "boxed in." Though qualified in law, her artistic journey is guided by instinct. Her works are contemporary yet unmistakably Indian in temperament, applying Cubism with the vivid colors and textures of everyday India. Her artistic compositions often feature a glowing circle, a symbol of sun in the centre, exuding vibrant energy and optimism. Drawing on a family history in textile dyes, she believes, "Handmade art still carries a depth that technology cannot ever replicate in a New Digital India."



Makarsankranti-Mamta Malhotra
Acrylic on Canvas



Jal Thal Nabh-Bharati Shah
Acrylic on Canvas



Mamta Malhotra
Artist

Mamta Malhotra, a qualified architect, portrays the spirit of Varanasi - its architecture, the Ganges, and its timeless pace. Born in Mumbai but raised across varied landscapes such as Kashmir, Pune, Gangtok and Bhutan, her artworks reflect the city not only as a place but as "an architectural skyline full of history and relevance."

Her paintings capture the "ephemeral beauty and fragility of Varanasi," driven by concern for ecological preservation and cultural erosion. Having exhibited internationally, she believes art must urge society to reconsider its direction and "rethink the steps we take," stressing that "India's creative future will flourish only if it stays rooted in nature, memory and the cultural depth built over centuries."